

INK & PANEL COMIC EXCHANGE

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1. Introduction & Project Context

This Technical Improvement Document covers the adjustments and bug fixes made to the *Ink & Panel Comic Exchange* website during the Milestone 3 coding phase. The goal of this platform is to act as a structured, stylized online store and community exchange hub that connects local student artists and comic book collectors around the Braamfontein student district.

When building interactive features with JavaScript, transitioning from static HTML structures to interactive layouts often causes unexpected interface bugs. Testing the site locally revealed a few functionality flaws where different scripts conflicted with the layout styling rules. This report breaks down why those specific visual and structural bugs occurred and documents how they were resolved in the global CSS sheets and primary script files.

2. Problem Identification & Bug Analysis

While doing test runs of the interface, two prominent frontend issues emerged inside the main collection grids when interacting with the search bar:

The Core Logic Collision: When the live search filter scans the layout, it changes hidden elements to a flex state. This unintentionally overrides standard display settings, causing repeating elements to stack up awkwardly on the screen.

First, the genre filter buttons and the text search bar conflicted with one another. Because the individual comic entries are tucked inside separate container grids to create an asymmetric layout, typing a search term forced all hidden sections to open up at the same time. This caused the "Back to Main Genres" navigation controls from each vault to stack on top of one another down the page, cluttering the UI. Second, varying description text lengths caused card alignment to break. The entry for *Blue Spring Ride* had a significantly longer description box than the others, which made the paragraph spill out past its borders and look disjointed against the neubrutalist background layout.

3. Refinement Changelog Matrix

The table below lays out the specific problems found during local browser testing, why they were happening, the exact updates made to the code, and how they fixed the visual experience.

WEBSITE PART	BUG IDENTIFIED	CODE ADJUSTMENT / SOLUTION	FINAL RESULT
Live Search Input Bar	Typing into the search input bar created duplicate "Back to Main Genres" buttons (<code>.back-to-categories-btn</code>) stacking on the screen together (showing up to 4 duplicate elements during Shojo searches).	Modified the search input event listener loop in <code>script.js</code> . Added a new selector to grab all the back buttons inside the vaults and apply <code>display: none;</code> while a search query is active. The buttons show up normally again when the search field is emptied.	A clean, user-friendly search view that hides redundant elements and shows only the exact comics searched for.
Comic Book Product Cards	Longer summary descriptions ran past the bottom borders of the layout box, clipping text on entries like <i>Blue Spring Ride</i> .	Removed fixed pixel heights from the product card selectors in <code>style.css</code> . Replaced them with a flexible layout rule using <code>min-height: 160px;</code> and a flexible <code>flex-grow: 1;</code> property on the white text info boxes.	Cards across the rows now scale uniformly together to cleanly contain different lengths of text.
Interactive Contact Map	The contact section lacked a visual way for users to locate the physical storefront location.	Linked the third-party Leaflet.js map library in the HTML files and script files, feeding in regional geographic canvas coordinates specifically set to the Juta Street storefront (<code>-26.1929, 28.0373</code>).	A fully functioning map renders natively on load, complete with a custom comic-themed popup marker pointing to the shop.

4. Testing & Code Verification

These script and stylesheet changes have been tested directly inside local browser viewports. Modifying the search bar code to query elements live on input rather than saving a static list at startup removes all interface friction and layout conflicts. Similarly, utilizing flexible layout rules inside the CSS sheet instead of rigid boundaries allows paragraphs of text to sit comfortably inside their grids without breaking. These patches completely finish the functional features needed for Milestone 3, ensuring the project codebase is stable and prepared for GitHub Pages hosting deployment.